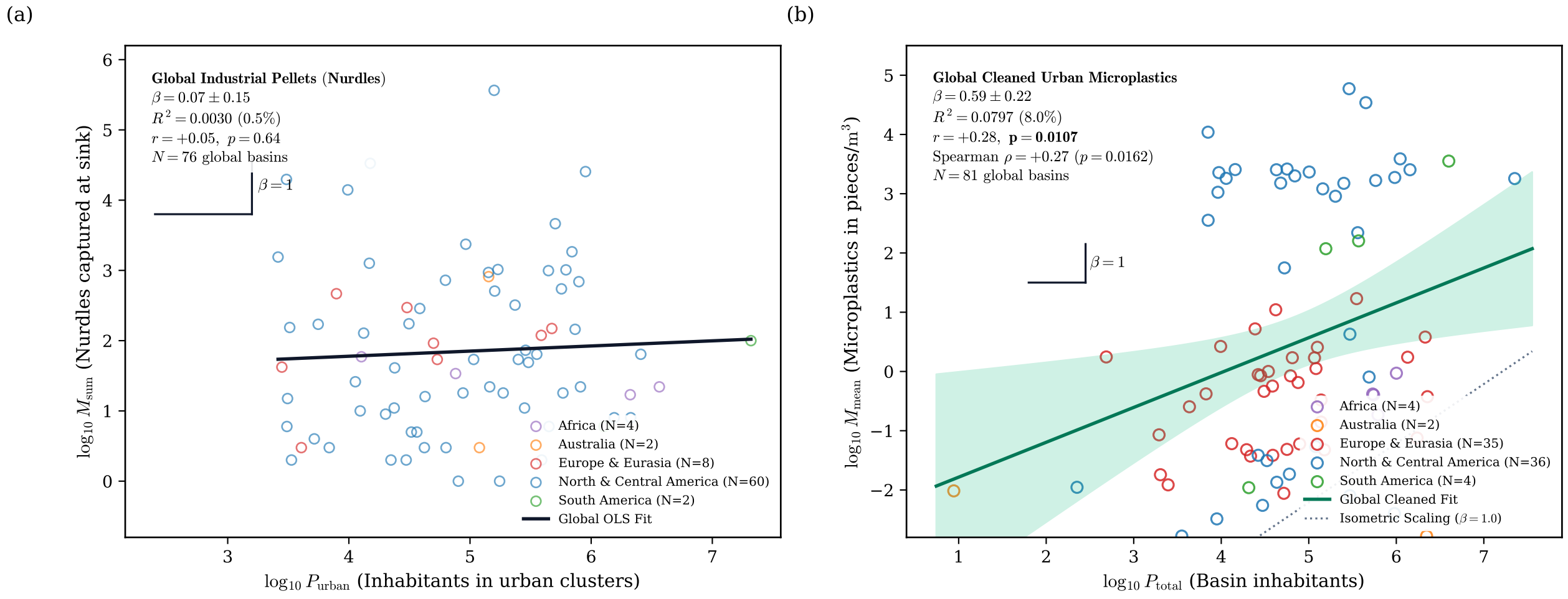

(a)
Global Industrial Pellets (Nurdles)
$\beta = 0.07 \pm 0.15$
$R^2 = 0.0030$ (0.5%)
$r = +0.05$, $p = 0.64$
$N = 76$ global basins
$\beta = 1$
Africa (N=4)
Australia (N=2)
Europe & Eurasia (N=8)
North & Central America (N=60)
South America (N=2)
Global OLS Fit
$\log_{10} M_{\text{sum}}$ (Nurdles captured at sink)
$\log_{10} P_{\text{urban}}$ (Inhabitants in urban clusters)
(b)
Global Cleaned Urban Microplastics
$\beta = 0.59 \pm 0.22$
$R^2 = 0.0797$ (8.0%)
$r = +0.28$, $\mathbf{p = 0.0107}$
Spearman $\rho = +0.27$ ($p = 0.0162$)
$N = 81$ global basins
$\beta = 1$
Africa (N=4)
Australia (N=2)
Europe & Eurasia (N=35)
North & Central America (N=36)
South America (N=4)
Global Cleaned Fit
Isometric Scaling ($\beta = 1.0$)
$\log_{10} M_{\text{mean}}$ (Microplastics in pieces/m$^3$)
$\log_{10} P_{\text{total}}$ (Basin inhabitants)